

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 1055

By Haile

A RESOLUTION to honor Rita Taylor for her top-five finish in WKRN's Remarkable Women campaign.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly take great pleasure in paying tribute to a lady who has eschewed the materialistic attitude so prevalent in our society to help those most in need; and

WHEREAS, Rita Taylor of Portland is indeed a "Remarkable Woman" who is always ready to embark upon a new adventure, usually with her husband, John; and

WHEREAS, a few days after her thirtieth birthday, Mrs. Taylor was forced to face her own mortality when she was diagnosed with non-Hodgkin lymphoma; and

WHEREAS, since surviving that ordeal, she has lived a happy and purposeful life and committed herself to paying it forward through countless deeds in service to her fellow human beings; and

WHEREAS, Rita Taylor has traveled the world on mission trips to the Amazon in Brazil, Honduras, and Kenya, helping fit glasses and giving the gift of sight; and

WHEREAS, she also conducted a prison ministry for women, hosting Bible study, talent shows, and arts and crafts, through which she helped many women find a new start in life; and

WHEREAS, for nearly thirty years, Mrs. Taylor hosted and performed in puppet shows in Portland schools to teach students about the dangers of drugs and alcohol; and

WHEREAS, for the past eight years, her Taylor's Stayin' Alive Divas have put on a rousing show in Portland to raise money for the American Cancer Society and remind people to stay on top of their health; and

WHEREAS, Rita and John Taylor volunteer weekly at Hands of Hope Food Pantry and make deliveries on Saturdays to seniors who are homebound; and

WHEREAS, in addition to the undying gratitude of the many people she has helped, Rita Taylor has twice been named Citizen of the Year by the Portland Chamber of Commerce, a most befitting honor that reflects the high regard in which she is held by her community; and

WHEREAS, this devoted wife, mother, friend, neighbor, and self-proclaimed Kansas farm girl has touched the lives of many through her positive outlook and her devotion to helping others, and she is most deserving of our approbation; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor Rita Taylor for her top-five finish in WKRN's Remarkable Women campaign, commend her bountiful public service, and extend to her our best wishes for much continued success and happiness.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.